

freeze to a halt and potentially crash the server. The motivation for a DOS attack can have many reasons, including financial profit or just malicious fun.

7.2.18 DDOS or Distributed Denial of Service

A DDOS attack would be what happens when a botnet is used to carry out the attack. See Botnet and Denial of Service.

7.2.19 Firewall

A software program or a hardware device used to filter the data that passes between your computer or network and the internet. Software firewalls are directly installed on your PC while hardware firewalls are connected to the entry point to your network from the internet.



Comodo is a software firewall used in Windows

7.2.20 Freeware

Programs that you can use for free without having to pay anything for them. Some software authors may request a donation, but in essence, the software program is completely free to use whether you donate or not. In some cases, the freeware version will be the younger cousin of a commercial offering of the same product. The commercial software will contain many more features than the freeware. The freeware then becomes a marketing vehicle for the commercial product.

7.2.21 Hacker

Generally referred to as a person who hacks or breaks into computers. The term hacking has undergone a mind shift in the past decade or so and has evolved to mean something fun and enjoyable. Hacking has evolved into a counterculture in its own right and has also taken on heroic and romantic overtones much like the ideas behind the likes of Robin Hood and the others. Hackers try to distant themselves from their evil cousins, the ones who hack into computers or networks with criminal or harmful intent.